

Business Economics



Marcelo Ortiz M.
Fall

Universitat Pompeu Fabra · Department of Economics and Business

Your Instructor

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Course Goals

An applied business economics course built around real cases and managerial decisions.

Connect theoretical insights to real business decisions: how to govern a firm.

Spend less time developing formal theory and more time applying it.

Think like an economist about managers, employees, and firm behavior.

- Present a business case (x2).
- Articulate critical economic arguments clearly.

Course Overview

01 Human Behavior and Economic Rationality

03 Coordination through Contracts

05 Vertical Integration

02 Markets and Organizations

04 Labor Relations and Teams

06 Corporate Governance

Evaluations

Before class

Read the compulsory chapters and articles for each topic.

Grading

50% case presentations

50% final exam

Case presentation rubric

- **5 points:** correct and clear use of concepts in the real case
- **3 points:** correct and clear answers during Q&A
- **2 points:** non-verbal communication and convincing speech

Final exam

Questions based on cases and class examples.

Case Presentations

Use a recent business-press article to apply a core concept from the course.

Article and concept

Describe the relevant theory and show how it applies to the article's case.

Format and timing

Present after the related theory session. Each group has 10 minutes, followed by 5 minutes for Q&A.

Organisation

Groups choose dates; the instructor selects presenters. Seminar sessions = coaching.

Calendar and Seminars

- See the course calendar.
- Seminar attendance is mandatory for groups presenting in the following week.